I Can be a Notebreaker

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/56004664.

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

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Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra)

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Fluff and Angst, Hurt/Comfort, Emotional Hurt/Comfort, Adora Needs Therapy (She-Ra), Adora Is a Mess (She-Ra), Post-Canon

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by AstrynSerene

Summary

Adora finds an old letter she'd written during the war, and she isn't happy to remember it.

Notes

I got the idea for this little oneshot from Ginny (@aoiveaeart) and MilyRose (@MilyRoseWish) on Twitter.

Hope you enjoy some angst and hurt/comfort :)

See the end of the work for more notes

Adora had forgotten it even existed. It had been written so many years ago. Well, two and a half years ago- but still! Buried beneath clothes and keepsakes at the bottom of her wardrobe, the memory of creating it had slipped her mind. Until now, that is.

With the war over and due to all of the rebuilding efforts, space was needed in the castle. Glimmer had given her and Catra a suite in the west wing, a bedroom, bathroom, and sitting room combo that would be theirs. Thus, she had been spending the last several hours moving things from her old room, and had stumbled upon the old letter when she got to her wardrobe. Tears ran down her face not even thirty seconds after she unfolded the page, words of heartbreak and defeat shakily scattered across the paper.

"You are my enemy now, and you always will be."

"I have no more hope now, and that makes me sad. So sad."

"I miss you Catra, and I will always miss you."

"I'm going to try and remember the good things about you…

…the bad things… those break my heart."

"I'm sorry things ended up like this…"

"…I wouldn't do things any other way."

Gasping, Adora fell to her knees, covering her mouth with her hand as her eyes scanned the page over and over again. Each word felt like a direct stab to her heart, knowing everything she knows now.

Catra had never been evil- not truly. She didn't know any better, or any other way, just like Adora hadn't. She was a victim of her environment, and she couldn't see a way out of the Horde like Adora could.

She knew now that Catra had always been good. She had just had it beaten down by Shadow Weaver over and over again. A week or so after the war ended, Catra had told her how she'd almost left to follow Adora, not long after she'd defected. Then Hordak had promoted her to Force Captain, and everything changed.

Anger coursed through Adora's veins thinking about writing this stupid letter. She knew back then she had no clue of the truth, and was only writing what she knew as the truth. Now though, she had no intention of keeping the thing around, and she definitely did not want Catra to find this. It would break her heart all over again, and if there was one thing Adora was a thousand percent sure of- it was that Catra had more than suffered enough.

She glared at the words, crushing the page between her fingers before starting to rip the paper to shreds. She didn't want to be able to read a single word of it again. She didn't want anyone to ever know the contents of the paper. She choked out a sob as she continued to rage war against the page, panting heavily once there was nothing left but tiny specks and shards of the letter left. There wasn't a single word intact anymore, and even recognizable letters were few and far in between. She stared at the mess in front of her before breaking into tears again. She covered her face with her trembling hands, her body shaking as she tried to calm herself down.

"Adora?"

Breath hitching, the blonde looked up with a panicked gaze as Catra cautiously strolled into the room.

"Are you okay…?" She noticed the shredded bits of paper scattered in front of Adora, but wasn't sure how that would lead to- *this*.

"I- I'm fine-" Adora whimpered, looking at the floor as her girlfriend approached, crouching in front of her.

"Clearly something is going on. Can I hug you? Hold your hand?"

Nodding quickly, Adora softly launched herself into the brunette's arms as soon as they were opened to her, "I- I'm sorry!"

Catra sighed, gently combing her fingers through Adora's hair. That had been the first change when she moved to Brightmoon- Adora's ponytail was always out when they were in the castle now. She occasionally wore it up when they went out to help rebuild or spar in the gardens, but otherwise, it was down or half up in a messy bun. She'd also found new ways to talk Adora through times like this- apologizing for something she likely shouldn't be, "Why do you think you need to say sorry to me?"

"I- I- I just-"

"Breathe…" She reminded in a whisper, her tail wrapping around Adora's thigh, "Does it have to do with this- well, what *used* to be a piece of paper?"

Another nod, and Catra kissed her forehead, "Okay, well, what was on it?" Now Adora shook her head, frantically and biting her lip.

"No- no, no… you can't- nobody can- nobody needs to see…"

That concerned Catra even further. What was so horrible that she didn't want anyone else to know what had been written down? The things that came to mind made Catra's heart rate increase. She knew Adora had been under pressure- so much pressure - and had told her so many times how alone she often felt, especially in the last year and when she was struggling to access She-Ra. Had her mind been that deep in despair and depression? She thought Adora would tell her about something like that though…

Catra took a deep breath. There was no reason to assume it was anything like that without some kind of confirmation from her partner. Instead, she continued to gently caress her hair, calming her own nerves so she could focus on Adora, "Okay, that's fine, nobody needs to see…" *Not like anyone* could *see with how much*

Adora had mauled the page, "Can you at least- give me some sort of idea what was on it so I can help?"

"It…It was uhm…" Adora sniffed, wiping her eyes as she pushed herself a little further into Catra's arms, "It was a letter I wrote. I… I was upset because I thought… I thought you were- never going to join the Rebellion, that we would never…" Unable to continue, Adora buried her face in her partner's shoulder.

While it made Catra's heart ache in a different way, hearing that alleviated her concerns of what else that letter could have been about, "Well, whatever it was is in the past now."

"I- I know I just… I don't-"

"Shh…" Catra peppered gentle kisses across Adora's face, "Whatever it was, you destroyed it, right?"

Adora nodded.

"Nobody will ever read it again, and you can move on from it now. It's gonna be okay." Catra promised, smiling when Adora nodded again, kissing her cheek gently, "Would it help if we cleaned it up and threw the pieces in the fireplace?"

"Yeah… Actually, yes, that would be great, thank you…"

"Alright, come on princess." Catra helped the blonde to her feet. They found a broom and swept the pieces up, putting them into a cup, before taking them to their new suite, where they proceeded to light the fireplace and dump the cup's contents into the flames. Watching the pieces fold and burn into ash was everything Adora needed in that moment. Maybe one day she would find the courage to tell Catra what the letter had actually contained, but now- just a few months after the war? No way.

"I love you, Catra…"

"I love you too, princess." Catra smiled, pulling her into a gentle kiss, "How about we take a break to walk in the gardens for a bit,

then finish moving our things.”

“Sounds perfect.”

End Notes

I'd love to know what you think! <3

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!